



Glossary

24x7 A period or window of service availability that covers 24 hours day, seven days a week.

3GL see THIRD-GENERATION PROGRAMMING LANGUAGE.

4GL see FOURTH-GENERATION PROGRAMMING LANGUAGE.

A

ABT see APPLIED BUSINESS TECHNOLOGY.

Acceptance The approval, typically by a client or user, of a project deliverable.

Access Control The ability to manage which users or groups of users may have the privilege to retrieve, create, update, or delete data held in a repository, such as a relational database.

Activation A logical event corresponding to the enabling of one high level business function at one site for one business unit. Each activation represents a discrete unit of work that we can predict and measure.

Actuals Information gathered during a project concerning the actual amount of time, finances or resources expended on a task.

Administration Server The machine from which a user, typically an administrator, runs programs that maintain and update an Oracle Applications database. For example, AutoInstall and AutoPatch are both run on this machine to install, upgrade, or update the database, which may reside on another machine (the database server).

Advocate An individual who supports the project within the client environment, without being involved in the project's implementation. An advocate may be a formal or informal leader within the organization.

Agent A generic term for a party which is responsible for the execution and completion of a process step. An agent may be an organizational unit, a functional unit, a business system, an employee role, an external system, or an external party such as a customer or supplier.

Agent Channel A horizontal division on a process flow diagram that indicates which agent performs which particular functions within the process being modeled.

AIM see APPLICATION IMPLEMENTATION METHOD.

Adragogy The field of adult-centered learning.

Applet A Java program that is downloaded to a desktop client from a web server, and run within a Java-enabled web browser or appletviewer.

Appletviewer A program that runs a Java applet or application.

Application A collection of program modules that work together to support a set of related business functions; see also MODULE.

Application Extension A collective term referring to any of several custom program approaches to a business requirement that is not satisfied by Oracle Applications, including modification of base Oracle Application code, custom extensions or configurable extensions; see also CUSTOMIZATION.

Application Servers Machines that reside in a middle tier, between desktop clients and a high-end, or back-end, tier. Desktop clients send their requests to application servers, which process the request by sending it to another server, such as the database server. In this manner, the desktop clients never connect directly to the database server. The forms server and web server are types of application servers; see also TIER.

Application Environment (Oracle) A complete application installation along with other utilities used for business mapping, design, build, testing, or training. Usually, an application environment includes setups and test data to support business modeling, and procedures exist to recover to controlled starting points after sessions are complete.

Application Fit A recorded match between some aspect of a business requirement and the capability or features of the application system that satisfies the requirement.

Application Functional Configuration (Oracle) The definition of key architectural setup parameters in an application instance or product group to reflect the financial and operating environment of the business organizations that transact within that application instance or product group.

Application Gap A recorded variance between some aspect of a business requirement and the capability or features of the application system that are necessary to satisfy the requirement.

Application Implementation Method (AIM) A method that comprises a flexible approach for implementing Oracle Applications.

Application Instance A unique set of application tables and processes. Note that two instances of the same version of an application may share one set of program modules but they will not share the same set of application tables.

Application Interface A mechanism used to transfer data between applications. A data flow between applications is always implemented as a set of one or more application interfaces; see also NEAR REAL-TIME INTERFACE and REAL-TIME INTERFACE.

Application Process An indication of the sequential execution of a series of system functions, possibly including manual functions as well; see also MANUAL FUNCTION, SYSTEM FUNCTION, and SYSTEM PROCESS.

Application System An automated collection of business functions, entities, modules, technology platforms, and documentation that performs a specified set of business functions; see also BUSINESS SYSTEM, MODULE, PLANNED RESPONSE SYSTEM, and SYSTEM FUNCTION.

Applications Distributed Interface (Oracle)

An interface between similar or dissimilar Oracle Applications products that have data stored in multiple separate databases. The databases may or may not be resident at multiple sites (data centers). The corollary of this is that applications distributed interfaces may exist at a single site.

Applications Interface (Oracle) An interface between similar or dissimilar Oracle Application products that have data stored in the same database. The interface may or may not be supported within the standard package products.

Applied Business Technology (ABT) A company that manufactures tools to profile, estimate, and plan projects. Oracle Services has a global licensing agreement with ABT. Oracle Method makes use of Project Workbench, Methods Architect, and Project Bridge Modeler as its worldwide methods and project management software standard; see also PROJECT BRIDGE MODELER and PROJECT WORKBENCH.

Approach A variation or subset of a method, packaged in order to efficiently support the delivery of a service; see also TECHNIQUE.

Arm's Length Transaction An inter-company transaction that is treated as a third party transaction.

Assessment The process of determining the value, extent, or significance of pre-determined topics for investigation. Methods may include surveys (questionnaires, interviews), observation, testing, and content analysis.

Attribute 1. Any detail that serves to qualify, identify, classify, quantify, or express the state of an entity; any description of a *thing of significance*. 2. A database object that links or relates the values of two dimensions. For example, you might define an attribute that relates the Sales District dimension to the Region dimension so that you can select data for sales districts according to region.

Audience A group of information recipients who possess similar communication and organizational attributes, e.g. content needs, communication styles, work emphases, etc. In a communication intervention, the audience is not passive, in that it shares the work of the project through two-way communication and direct involvement in the design and implementation of the project process.

AutoText Entry Microsoft Word allows you to store frequently used text, graphics, and other items and quickly insert them into documents. These stored items are referred to as AutoText entries. If you store text and graphics as AutoText entries, you can retrieve them by clicking a button, typing a few keystrokes, or choosing a command. Components of the Deliverable Templates are stored as AutoText entries in global templates used to store boilerplate text; see also **BOILERPLATE TEXT**.

B

Background Process A non-interactive process that runs in an operating system environment and performs a task.

Backup and Recovery Strategy A storage and recovery strategy that protects against business information loss resulting from hardware, software, or network faults.

Bandwidth The amount of data that can be sent through a network connection, measured in bits per second (BPS). The speed and capacity of a network depend on both bandwidth and latency; see also **LATENCY**.

Base Language The language used for seed data of products that do not support multiple languages. (Multiple language products include FND, AK, AS, AX, and AZ).

Baseline 1. A starting point or condition against which future changes are measured.
2. A named set of object versions which fixes a configuration at a particular point in time. A baseline normally represents a milestone or key deliverable of a project; see also **CURRENT BUSINESS BASELINE**.

Bid and Proposal Management (BPM)

Specifies the process, tasks, responsibilities, and deliverables regarding how business opportunities are qualified and responded to, eventually leading to the issue of an authorized bid to a client.

Billable Project Expenses The project expenses that are billable to a client; see also **PROJECT EXPENSES**.

Billable Utilization The utilization that is billable to a client; see also **UTILIZATION**.

Black Box Test A test of all or part of an application system based upon fulfilling business requirements or meeting functional specifications. A black box test does not require an understanding of the actual code under test. A system test is usually a black box test.

Boilerplate Text Prewritten collection of words, sentences, headings, and formatting in a template that you can modify to suit a specific need; see also **AUTOTEXT ENTRY**.

Bottom-Up Estimate A task-level estimate derived by calculating the estimating factors critical to completion of each task; see also **ESTIMATING FACTOR**.

BPM see **BID AND PROPOSAL MANAGEMENT**.

BPR see **BUSINESS PROCESS REENGINEERING**.

BRS see **BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS SCENARIO**.

Browser see **WEB BROWSER**.

Budget A plan for determining in advance the expenditure of time, money, etc.

Business An enterprise, commercial entity, or firm in either the private or public sector, concerned with providing products or services to satisfy customer requirements.

Business Aim A statement of business intent measured subjectively; for example, to move up market, or to develop a sustainable level of growth; usually strategic or tactical with a 3-5 year horizon.

Business Area The set of business processes within the scope of a project.

Business Constraint Any external, management, or other factor that restricts a business or system development in terms of resource availability, dependencies, timescales, or some other factor.

Business Data Mapping Verification that the underlying table structures and attributes will support business processes.

Business Function Something an enterprise does, or needs to do, in order to achieve its objectives; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM, BUSINESS PROCESS, MANUAL FUNCTION, and SYSTEM FUNCTION.

Business Function Model A representation of all the business functions within a defined scope. A wide range of techniques is available for modeling business functions; see also FUNCTION DECOMPOSITION and FUNCTION HIERARCHY.

Business Goal A statement of business intent.

Business Location A uniquely identifiable geographic location, site, or place from which one or more business units may wholly or partly operate.

Business Model A model or collection of models representing the definition of key components of a business. Components may include models of processes, objectives, functions, and information; see also BUSINESS PROCESS MODEL, ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM, and FUNCTION HIERARCHY.

Business Object A physical or logical object of significance to a business; for example, a sales order, department, assembly, item, balance, or invoice. A business object is analogous to a class in object-oriented terminology.

Business Objective Business conditions which, if met, will solve the business problem statement. Well-defined objectives are measurable and often relate directly to business processes and deliverables; see also PROBLEM STATEMENT.

Business Organization Any part of a business treated for any purpose as a separate unit within the parent business organization; for example, a department, division, or subsidiary; see also BUSINESS UNIT.

Business Organization Type A classification of a business organization into one of several functional categories. Each business organization type has a distinct set of business requirements. All the business organizations of a certain type will typically require similar applications and system capabilities. A given site may house one or more business organization types. Since business organizations may be related in a hierarchy, a high level business organization may be composed of several business organizations of different types. For the purposes of application architecture analysis and design, it is generally useful to decompose the hierarchy of business organizations until it is composed of atomic organization types; see also CUSTOMER SERVICE, DISTRIBUTION, FINANCE, HUMAN RESOURCES, INFORMATION SYSTEMS, MANUFACTURING, MARKETING, PLANNING, RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT, and SALES.

Business Priority A statement of the level or urgency of important business needs.

Business Process The complete response that a business makes to an event. A business process entails the execution of a sequence of one or more process steps. It has a clearly defined deliverable or outcome. A Business Process is defined by the business event that triggers the process, the inputs and outputs, all the operational steps required to produce the output, the sequential relationship between the process steps, the business decisions that are part of the event response, and the flow of material and/or information between process steps; see also BUSINESS FUNCTION, BUSINESS PROCESS MODEL, and EVENT RESPONSE.

Business Process Model The collection of process flow diagrams that comprise the complete set of business processes within the application scope; see also PROCESS FLOW DIAGRAM.

Business Process Reengineering (BPR) The activity by which an enterprise reexamines its goals and how it achieves them, followed by a disciplined approach of business process redesign. A method that supports this activity.

Business Requirement A formal statement that describes application features necessary to support a business process step.

Business Requirements Mapping An activity that describes the business requirements for a business process in business language, optionally compares the current solution for a business requirement to a proposed solution and specifies details for the type and nature of the solution in a descriptive format. The deliverable can also be used as a record of key decisions, or as a placeholder in anticipation of additional detailed design documentation.

Business Requirements Scenario (BRS) A formal statement of the detailed business requirements for a business process, the source of these requirements, how these requirements will be satisfied (either by the application, manual process steps, workarounds or other application solutions), and what prototyping steps must be taken to prove the designs.

Business Rule A rule under which an organization operates. A policy or decision that influences the process step.

Business Solution Testing A technique by which management agrees that business requirements will be satisfied if the application and other tools perform as specified by process designs.

Business System A combination of people and automated applications organized to meet a particular set of business objectives; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM and PLANNED RESPONSE SYSTEM.

Business Unit Part of an organization treated for any purpose as a separate entity within the parent organization. Examples include a department or distribution center; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION.

Business View 1. A frequently used subset of information, readily intelligible to users and defined in business terms, derived from definitions held in an entity model. It is based on one entity and can encompass renamed attributes from the base entity or any other entity. 2. A custom-tailored presentation of the data in one or more tables. A business view can be thought of as a "stored query."

C

Cartridge A software component that, when linked with other cartridges, forms a complete software solution. Cartridges are "wrappers" around a program. The program may be written in any programming language, such as C, C++, or Java. The wrapper enables the program to interface with other cartridges on the same machine or across a network. Cartridges may be used in many places: the Oracle ConText Cartridge is an example of a data cartridge (residing on the database tier), while the Oracle Forms Load Balancing Cartridge is an example of an application cartridge (residing on the application tier).

Cascade Method Model of communication that begins at the top by having managers inform their direct reports, who then inform their direct reports, etc. so that information cascades down the organizational hierarchy until all stakeholders have received the necessary information. Effective in building commitment and cooperation among stakeholders, as most individuals prefer to receive information from their supervisors.

CASE see COMPUTER-AIDED SYSTEMS ENGINEERING.

Case Method the presentation of real or fictional situations or problems to learners to analyze, to discuss, and to recommend actions to be taken. Used to develop critical thinking skills and to gain new perceptions of concepts and issues.

CASE Tools A set of integrated Computer-Aided Systems Engineering (CASE) and application development tools that assist in software development, for example, analyzing business requirements, designing applications, generating application code, etc.

Certificate File A certificate file contains the identity of a "trusted source" that the desktop client uses to guarantee the authenticity of a JAR file. Information contained within the certificate file allows the desktop client to decrypt the digital signature of a JAR file. If the identity can be confirmed, the desktop client assumes the JAR file is safe to download and execute; see also DIGITAL SIGNATURE.

CDM see CUSTOM DEVELOPMENT METHOD.

Change A deviation from a currently established baseline.

Change Effort Any activity consciously undertaken by an enterprise, business unit, or individual, that will result in critical change in one or more areas of the organization, for example, new technology implementation; see also ORGANIZATIONAL EFFORT.

Change Management 1. The complete set of processes employed on a project to make sure that changes are implemented in a visible, controlled and orderly fashion. 2. The activity, or set of activities, undertaken to govern systematically the effects of organizational change. 3. A Focus Area Group within Program Management that incorporates all necessary Oracle Method processes to develop an integrated approach to change as part of a Program's Baseline Solution. 4. The management and control of organizational change, and its effects on staff, during a project. It includes key issues such as the impact of change on staff tasks, staff capabilities, retraining, cultural change and communication between the project team and staff in the organization.

Change Management Repository A system for maintaining configuration items. It provides other services such as version control, access control and information storage and retrieval which support the configuration management process.

Change Readiness A measure of an organization's state of readiness to realize change successfully; involves a consideration of an organization's high-impact leverage points for change, as well as any change impediments.

Change Request 1. A request for a change to the required behavior of a system, usually from a user as a result of reviewing current behavior. 2. The mechanism by which a change is requested, investigated, resolved and approved; see also IMPACT ANALYSIS.

Character Set A set of encoded binary values that represents the letters, numerals, and punctuation marks of a language, or of a group of languages that use similar written symbols. For example, the WE8ISO8859P1 character set can be used by English and many other languages that use a Latin-based alphabet and Arabic numerals. Terminals and printers handle text data by converting these encoded values to characters. A character set may also be called a codeset.

Class 1. A class refers to the delivery training to students on a certain topic(s). Usually, training is provided regarding Oracle applications such as bill of materials, work in process, etc. Training may also be provided regarding job policy and procedures, help desk operations, etc. 2. A description of a set of objects that share the same attributes, operations, methods, relationships, and semantics. A class may use a set of interfaces to specify collections of operations it provides to its environment. (UML 1.1 Semantics)

Class Session A class session consists of delivering a class to a specific set of students at a particular place and time.

Client A general term for the computer in a client/server configuration that requests services, data, or processing. The computer supplying the services, data, or processing is the server.

Client/Server A type of technical architecture that links many personal computers or workstations (clients) to one or more large processors (servers). Clients generally manage the user interface, possibly with some local data. Servers usually manage multiple-access databases, including ensuring data integrity and other invariants.

Client/Server Configuration A configuration in which one or several servers perform database processing or other functions for applications that are run on clients.

Coaching A technique of apprenticeship whereby the coach demonstrates and observes learners as they try to complete tasks and provides hints, help, and feedback as needed.

Codeset see CHARACTER SET.

Column A means of implementing an item of data within a table. It can be in character, date, or number format, and be optional or mandatory.

Common Business Function A business function that appears in more than one place in a hierarchy.

Communication Agent An individual who implements a communication activity, such as a communication event, who acts as a communication resource, information resource or channel.

Communication Campaign A series of activities undertaken to achieve the communication objectives for a particular audience.

Communication Event Those activities within the deployment of a communication campaign that are discrete and time-bound, such as a presentation, launch of a kiosk, or video conference.

Company A commercial business; see also BUSINESS.

Company Base Hardware Configuration The actual hardware configuration that supports the company base configuration; see also COMPANY BASELINE.

Company Baseline The Company Baseline is the supported configuration of hardware, software, bug patches, modifications, operating systems, etc. that is part of a common set of business systems for the entire enterprise. There may be lower level of Company Baselines such as a Latin America Baseline that is a subset of the Company Baseline.

Compensable Factors Aspects of a job that contribute to its level of compensation.

Competency Underlying and enduring characteristic of an individual that causes or predicts effective or superior performance in a job or activity.

Competency Model A set of underlying and enduring characteristics (such as skills and knowledge) of an individual that are required to perform a job effectively.

Completion Criteria Standards or rules which determine completion of a task to an acceptable level of quality.

Computer-Aided Systems Engineering (CASE) The combination of graphical, dictionary, generator, project management, and other software tools to assist computer development staff engineer and maintain high-quality systems, within the framework of a structured method.

Computer-Based Training Instructional technology with computer and software programs for individualized learning. The programs are designed to interface with the user in such a way as to simulate an encounter between a learning agent and a learner, for computer-assisted or -based learning; for example, the programs are configured to deliver instruction and evaluate learner progress; may include mechanisms that adapt the program to learner characteristics as the program progresses

Computer Network An interconnected group of computers.

Conceptual Architecture A high level model of an enterprise's business application that identifies the organizational and geographical deployment of the most critical application systems and the technology components required to support them. This model provides the direction for the detailed enterprise technical architecture analysis. It should reflect the vision of the client senior executive management for the future direction of the information systems in the enterprise.

Concurrent Manager A process manager that coordinates the processes generated by users' requests to run various data-intensive programs. An Oracle Applications product group can have several concurrent managers.

Concurrent Process A task run by a concurrent manager. A concurrent process runs simultaneously with interactive functions and other concurrent processes.

Concurrent Processing Server An Oracle Applications server that runs time-consuming, non-interactive tasks in the background. This server resides at the database tier of the internet computing architecture.

Concurrent Queue A list of concurrent requests awaiting completion. Each concurrent manager has its own queue of pending requests.

Concurrent Request A request issued to the concurrent processing server when you submit a non-interactive task, such as running a report.

Conference Room Pilot (CRP) A system test in an environment set up to simulate the future production environment.

Configuration A named set of configuration items. Configurations are used to hierarchically organize configuration items in order to facilitate their management; see also CONFIGURATION ITEM.

Configuration Change The implementation of one or more change requests which leaves the configuration in an internally consistent state; see also IMPACT ANALYSIS.

Configuration Item A deliverable or deliverable component which is placed under configuration management.

Configuration Management The process of managing hardware, software, data, and any other documentation needed during the development, testing, and implementation of information systems.

Congruence Model Organization model, based on open systems theory, that stresses the interdependence between systems and the ripple effect of inputs across systems. Views strategy as driven by organization context (inputs) -- company history, resources, the firm's environment, that require organizational transformation to maintain correspondence or balance between the interrelated systems.

Constraint see BUSINESS CONSTRAINT and BUSINESS RULE.

Consulting Grade Level A grade level assigned to Oracle Services consulting resources used to calculate the cost of a resource's labor; 1-Administrative Assistant to 10-Regional Vice President.

Context Diagram A high-level diagram, indicating the major functional components and major internal and external interdependencies of a system.

Contingency Work effort allotted in a workplan for all unforeseen but possible occurrences of additional work.

Contribution Margin see MARGIN AMOUNT and MARGIN PERCENTAGE.

Controlled Document A document which constitutes or represents a project deliverable for approval internally or by the client, and is subject to change control.

Controls Environmental information that affects what is possible; constraints or limits.

Conversion Execution An example of a Conversion Execution would be where open orders are converted from a legacy system to Oracle Order Entry in one region on a given date. Other regions may go live with Order Entry on a different date requiring other order entry Conversion Executions.

Conversion Fit Analysis A formal statement of subsystems and entities converted into the new applications database.

Core Tasks. The minimum set of tasks necessary to complete an Oracle Applications implementation or migration project.

Core Business Process A major, driver process that affects or influences business objectives. The set of business processes identified in association with the objectives represent the "core processes" of the business area.

Corporate Repository Location of a collection of documentation, customizations, modifications, or enhancements designed to alleviate the recreation of successfully completed work.

Corporation A group of businesses acting as part of a single legal entity.

Cost The amount allotted or spent to acquire, deliver or produce anything, for example, the cost of labor to deliver consulting services, the amount spent on incidental costs to deliver consulting services, the amount spent on hardware, software, etc.

CPM see CRITICAL PATH METHOD NETWORK.

CPU Support Identification (CSI) A number assigned to each Oracle customer. The number is required in order to use the Support hotline or RTSS. Associated with the CSI number is the client's name, RDBMS version, supported products, operating system, telephone, area code, and Technical contracts.

Critical Path Method (CPM) Network A network diagram that shows tasks, their dependency links, and their critical path.

Critical Success Factor (CSF) A business event, dependency, product, or other factor that, if not attained, would seriously impair the likelihood of achieving a business objective.

CRP see CONFERENCE ROOM PILOT.

CSF see CRITICAL SUCCESS FACTOR.

CSI see CPU SUPPORT IDENTIFICATION.

CT see CUSTOM TRAINING.

Current Business Baseline The set of business process and function models representing the current application system that supports the business area; see also BUSINESS AREA, BUSINESS PROCESS MODEL, and BUSINESS FUNCTION MODEL.

Custom Code Coding added to a packaged application or module generated by a CASE tool to implement functionality that the application or generator has not provided; see also CUSTOM EXTENSIONS.

Custom Development Method (CDM) A structured method for full life-cycle custom development projects; see also LINE OF BUSINESS.

Custom Extensions Custom modules that extend the functionality of packaged applications without modifying the base functionality; see also CUSTOM CODE.

Custom Support System A custom-built information system conceived, developed, and managed at the enterprise level. It provides a service to one or more sites or business units. Such systems are designed to be generic, flexible, and independent of the particular service sites. Examples of custom support systems are: enterprise data warehouses, data registry propagation systems, and distributed application data transport systems.

Custom Training (CT) An organizational change management area providing organizations with training programs designed to meet specific training needs identified through a preliminary training needs assessment. Custom training seeks to re-skill a work force to optimize performance with new technology.

Customer Service The business organization that 1. manages returns and repairs of products that may or may not have been purchased from the enterprise originally; 2. responds to customer complaints about service or products; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Customization A change made to the standard Oracle software which implements a solution to a gap.

Cut-Over Transition to a new application system in a live, production mode of operation.

D

Data Cleansing The transformation of data in its current state to a pre-defined, standardized format using packaged software or program modules.

Data Conversion The movement of data from a legacy system or application to a replacement application or subsystem.

Data Definition The specification of a data element to be maintained. The specification includes datatype, size, and rules about processing: for example, derivation, and validation; see also BUSINESS RULE.

Data Definition Language (DDL) A subset of SQL used to create, alter, drop, and otherwise change definitions of tables, views, and other database objects.

Data Dictionary 1. A part of a database that holds definitions of data elements, such as tables, columns, and views. 2. A set of database tables and views that contains administrative information about users, data storage, and privileges. It is created and maintained automatically.

Data Integration The movement of data between two co-existing systems. The interfacing of this data may occur once every hour, once a day, etc.

Data Integrity Testing Verification that converted data is accurate and functions correctly within a single subsystem or application.

Data Migration The movement of data from one database to another database – but not necessarily to a working application or subsystem tables.

Data Model A representation of the specific information requirements of a business area; see also ENTITY RELATIONSHIP MODEL.

Data Partitioning A technique to improve application performance or security by splitting tables across multiple locations.

Data Profile A description of the business conditions that are needed to test the application system.

Data Registry The master copy of the data associated with a business object. Several databases may share access to a common data registry to provide consistency and eliminate redundant entries across multiple applications and databases. An example of a data registry would be a shared customer master. All updates and changes would be made to the customer master data registry and are then propagated to subscribing sites. All systems requiring customer information would interface with the customer data registry.

Data Registry Interface An interface that transfers data registry data between similar or dissimilar applications.

Data Replication The copying of data to and from sites to improve local service response times and availability; frequently employed as part of a backup and recovery strategy.

Data Transfer The physical movement of data between applications, perhaps across sites.

Data Transformation The process of redefining data based on some predefined rules. The values are redefined based on a specific formula or technique.

Data Translation The process of redefining data in a manner differing between its original representation and its final representation.

Database A collection of data, usually in the form of tables or files, under the control of a database management system. The term can also refer to the software used to create, store, and manage this data—for example, the Oracle9.5i Server.

Database Architecture The collective application and database instances that comprise the complete system.

Database Function A callable routine executed within a database server environment.

Database Index A mechanism to locate and access data within a database. An index may quote one or more columns and be a means of enforcing uniqueness on their values.

Database Instance One set of database management processes and an allocated area in memory for managing those processes. Typically, a database instance is associated with one database. Note that a database instance may process data for one or more applications. There is always a one-to-one correspondence between an ORACLE instance and a system global area (SGA).

Database Management System (DBMS) A software environment that structures and manipulates data, and provides data security, recovery, and integrity.

Database Object A logical entity created and stored in a database. Tables, views, synonyms, indexes, sequences, stored procedures, and triggers are all examples of database objects.

Database Package An Oracle database object comprised of PL/SQL code allowing execution of code at the server based on specific events or triggers.

Database Server A software server on which the database holding Oracle Applications data resides. The database server processes SQL requests from other machines, such as forms servers and concurrent processing servers. The database server executes on a hardware platform server.

Database Schema see ORACLE ID.

Database Space The amount of disk space used by a set of database objects.

Dataflow A named flow of information between business functions, datastores, and external entities represented as an arrow on a dataflow diagram; see also BUSINESS FUNCTION, DATASTORE, and EXTERNAL ENTITY.

Dataflow Diagram A diagram representing the use of data by business functions; see also DATAFLOW, DATASTORE, EXTERNAL ENTITY, and PROCESS.

Dataflow Diagramming A technique for expressing the significant dataflows of a business system.

Datastore A temporary or permanent storage concept for logical data items used by specified business functions and processes.

DB2 An SQL-based database management system.

DDL see DATA DEFINITION LANGUAGE.

Decision A point in a process flow where there is a choice of possible paths. The outcome of the decision determines which path the flow follows.

Decision Point The diagrammatic representation, on a process flow diagram, of a decision which results in the subsequent execution of one of two or more alternative sequences of process steps. The decision is actually made during the execution of the previous process step. The decision point is shown after that step for diagrammatic convenience.

Decision Support System (DSS) An application primarily used to consolidate, summarize, or transform transaction data to support analytical reporting and trend analysis.

Deliverable Something a project must produce in order to meet its objectives. A deliverable must be tangible and measurable.

Deliverable Component A part or section of a deliverable. A deliverable component may be the output of a task step.

Deliverable Guideline A detailed description of a deliverable that includes: detailed description, usage, audience, and distribution, format guidelines, control, template, and samples; see also DELIVERABLE.

Deliverable Management The process of managing the creation, review, modification, and distribution of deliverables provided to a client. Software may be included as one of the managed deliverables.

Deliverable Template A tool designed to aid in production of a deliverable; a template that gives the format and structure of a deliverable; see also DELIVERABLE.

Delivery Vehicle The mechanism for producing or implementing something. For example, SQL* Forms is a vehicle to produce computer programs.

Demonstration Product Group A product group that includes predefined transaction data for Oracle Applications products. It is used primarily for system testing and user training. See also PRODUCT GROUP.

Dependency 1. An indication that one task cannot begin until another task has ended, or progressed to a certain specified level of completion; see also PREDECESSOR and SUCCESSOR. 2. A relationship between two modeling elements, in which a change to one modeling element (the independent element) will affect the other modeling element. (UML 1.1 Semantics)

Dependent Product An Applications product that is not licensed, but whose files are shared in part by a fully installed Applications product. A dependent product is also known as a shared product.

Deployment The total set of activities associated with the production implementation of a set of applications in specific location(s) at a particular point in time.

Desktop Client A computer that sends user requests to the forms server and handles responses such as screen updates, pop-up lists, graphical widgets, and cursor movements.

Detailed Deliverable A deliverable whose structure originated from a high level deliverable, but that contains significantly more detail; see also DELIVERABLE and HIGH-LEVEL DELIVERABLE.

Development Life-Cycle A complete process of developing computer systems.

Digital Signature A means of guaranteeing the authenticity of a program or collection of data, such as a JAR file. It is typically an encrypted message that contains the identity of the code's author. See also certificate file.

Distributed Concurrent Processing See PARALLEL CONCURRENT PROCESSING.

Distributed Directory Structure Applications product files installed in more than one file system (for example, when there is insufficient disk space in a single file system for all Applications product files).

Distributed Database A database that is physically located on more than one computer processor. It is connected via some form of communications network. An essential feature of a true distributed database is that users or programs work as if they had access to the whole database locally.

Distributed Processing The ability to have several computers working together in a network, where each processor runs different activities for a user, as required.

Distribution A high-level business function responsible for configuring the firmware parts of inventory, housing finished goods inventory (FGI), and shipping finished goods to customers or to internal sites; often synonymous with a business organization; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Distribution Management Distribution management is the process to manage the release and distribution of software in a controlled manner. This includes the kitting of software, documentation, patches and other components. It involves initial releases and subsequent patch tapes, upgrades and new releases. It also includes providing the organizational challenges of obtaining release approval from the Company Baseline Review Board (CBRB).

DSS see DECISION SUPPORT SYSTEM.

E

EBF see ELEMENTARY BUSINESS FUNCTION.

EF see ESTIMATING FACTOR.

Effort The amount of work, measured in person-hours, to perform a task.

Electronic Performance Support Systems An integrated electronic environment easily accessible by users and structured to provide immediate, individualized, on-line access to information, software, guidance, advice, assistance, data, images, tools, assessments, and monitoring systems to permit users to perform their jobs with a minimum of support and intervention by others.

Electronic Performance Support Tool Software designed to improve employee productivity by supplying immediate on-the-job access to integrated information, learning opportunities, and expert consultation with scope and sequence controlled by the user.

Element A thing of significance about which information is recorded; a component at the most useful, basic level.

Element Type Any element held in the repository is classified as a particular type. Examples of element type are entity, attribute, program module, process, table, diagram, and text. Occurrences or instances of these are called elements.

Elementary Business Function (EBF) A business function which if started, must either complete successfully or, if it cannot complete successfully, must undo any effects that it has had up to the point of failure. An elementary business function changes a business's data from one consistent state to another; see also FUNCTION HIERARCHY and COMPOSITE BUSINESS FUNCTION.

End User see USER.

Enterprise A group of departments, divisions, or companies which make up an entire business.

Enterprise Support Systems The set of all computer-based systems, documents, and procedures used in support of business enterprise operations.

Enterprise Technical Architecture (ETA) A series of rules, guidelines, and principles used by an organization to direct the process of acquiring, building, modifying, delivering, and integrating Information Technology resources throughout the enterprise. These resources can include equipment, software, business processors, protocols, standards, methodologies, IT organizational structures and more.

Entity A thing of significance, whether real or imagined, about which information needs to be known or held. It is implemented in a database as one or more tables.

Entity Integrity Rules The rules that specify valid values or combination of values for attributes of an entity. These may include unique identifiers, domains, and multi-attribute validation rules; see also BUSINESS RULE and REFERENTIAL INTEGRITY CONSTRAINT.

Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD) A diagram that pictorially represents entities, the relationships between them and the attributes used to describe them; see also ATTRIBUTE, ENTITY, and RELATIONSHIP.

Entity Relationship Model A type of data model. Part of the business model that consists of many Entity Relationship Diagrams; see also DATA MODEL.

Entity Test A detailed test of certain key data elements of a business entity that is being converted or interfaced from one system to another.

Environment File A command file that sets environment variables. Only servers running UNIX or Open VMS use these files. Windows NT servers use the Windows registry instead.

Environment Variable A variable maintained by the UNIX shell that can be referenced by any program running within the shell. Environment variables hold values used by many Oracle programs and utilities. On Windows NT, a string consisting of environment information, such as a drive, path, or filename, associated with a symbolic name. Use the System option in the Control Panel or the set command from the Windows NT command prompt to define environment variables.

ERD see ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM.

Ergonomics The use of good design techniques that emphasize ease-of-use.

Estimate A preliminary calculation of the time and cost of work to be undertaken. The *construct* option calculates estimates using bottom-up, percent adjustment, or top-down techniques in Project Bridge Modeler; see also BOTTOM-UP ESTIMATE, PERCENT ADJUSTMENT ESTIMATE, WORK ESTIMATE, and TOP-DOWN ESTIMATE.

Estimated Function Point Count 7 Function Points per System Entity + 5 Function Points per System Function.

Estimating Factor (EF) A metric that describes an important project characteristic, used to estimate either the amount of effort that project tasks will take, or project risk or complexity. The best EFs are those that represent counts (number of users, objects); see also BOTTOM-UP ESTIMATE.

Estimating Formula A formula that uses estimating factors to derive an estimate for a task.

Estimating Guideline Text which describes in detail how a task is estimated.

Estimating Model The combination of estimating factors and estimating formulas necessary to completely estimate a route.

ETA see ENTERPRISE TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE.

Event 1. An occurrence in a business's environment to which that business must respond; see also BUSINESS SYSTEM and EVENT RESPONSE. 2. An occurrence or happening of significance to a task or program, such as the completion of an asynchronous input/output operation. 3. A transaction or other activity that affects the records in a file.

Event Mechanism A permissible way in which an event is recognized. For instance, a Customer Order may be entered into the system if received by fax, phone, mailed-in purchase order or internet-facilitated, but not by markings on a scratch pad.

Event Response An event and the business process which responds to that event; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM, BUSINESS SYSTEM, and EVENT.

Executive Information System (EIS) A reporting application targeted for use by executives. Usually such applications have extremely user-friendly, graphical interfaces with a small local datastore derived from connection to a data warehouse. It is often used synonymously with decision support system.

Expense The amount of money allotted or spent to cover incidental costs (for example, travel and living) or the cost of something (hardware, software, etc.) to deliver consulting services.

Export Utility An Oracle Database Server utility used to write database data to operating system files external to the database. These files can then be used with the Import utility to read the data back into the same database or into a different one.

Expense Reimbursement Expenses for reimbursement by the client either allotted or received.

Extension Enhancements to an Oracle Applications system made to fit the needs of a specific user community.

Extensibility (CASE Dictionary) It is often useful to add new elements, properties, and associations into the Dictionary. This is achieved by a facility known as user extensibility.

External Business Function A business function that is outside the scope of the application system, that acts as a source or recipient of dataflows.

External Entity An entity that is outside the scope of application system, that acts as a source or recipient of dataflows. An external entity might be a person, a business unit, another application system, or any other thing that might provide or receive information from a function within the application system; see also ENTITY.

External Equity Measure of the fairness of a job's compensation when compared to the labor market as a whole within the region, profession, or industry; see also INTERNAL EQUITY.

External Process Step A process step that is performed by an agent outside the business area; see also INTERNAL PROCESS STEP and PROCESS STEP.

F

Fee A charge, compensation, or payment for a service or product.

Feedback Response, including corrections, additions, and approval, elicited from users, stakeholders, sponsors, and others, to any deliverable or deliverable component.

Feedback Session A meeting organized to present work in progress in order to gain feedback; see also FEEDBACK.

FH see FUNCTION HIERARCHY.

Field A means of implementing an item of data within a file. It can be in character, date, number, or other format and be optional or mandatory.

File Transfer Protocol (FTP) The physical movement of data files between applications, often across sites.

Finance A high-level business function that handles accounting and financial functions of a company; for example, corporate, division, and subsidiary headquarters; often synonymous with a business organization; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Financial Organization A business organization that performs one or more financial business functions. The data is segregated for organizational management or security. When mapped onto Oracle Applications, a financial organization is required to have a defined set of books. This concept is more general than the set of books. It is replacing the set of books as the key financial application functional configuration parameter in releases of Oracle Applications starting with 10.6.

Flexfield A user-definable field in an Oracle Application that is made up of segments. Each segment has a name you assign and a set of valid values.

Focus Area (Project) 1. A group of associated Oracle Method processes that produce program level deliverables during the Baseline Solution Development stage. 2. A scoped area of the client organization with common responsibilities and information requirements. The focus area provides the scope for incremental development efforts and may be referred to as the INCREMENT. The focus area can overlap business functions or may reside in a specific business function.

Focus Group A small group selected to provide opinions and responses to topics or issues presented in a group setting; an assessment technique.

Foreign Key One or more columns in a relational database table that implement a many-to-one relationship that the table in question has with another table or with itself.

Form 1. A program for viewing or entering information. Normally it refers to a rectangular area of the screen, which has the appearance of a paper form, through which you can view or manipulate information in a database. 2. A logical collection of fields, regions, and graphical components that appears on a single screen. Oracle Applications forms resemble paper forms used to run a business. Data is entered by typing information into the form.

Formal Build Construction of an information system by the well established steps of specify, code, test, and correct.

Format The type of data that an attribute or column may represent; for example, character, date, number, sound, or image.

Forms Client A Java applet that runs on a desktop client and provides the user interface and interaction with a forms server.

Forms Metrics Server A machine that manages and distributes requests from forms clients among multiple forms servers; see also LOAD BALANCING and METRICS SERVER.

Forms Server A type of application server that hosts the Oracle Forms Server engine. It mediates between the desktop client and the database, providing input screens to the desktop client and creating or changing database records based on user actions.

Fourth-Generation Programming Language (4GL) A language that manipulates high-level objects, such as screen items and database tables, by declaring what is to be done to them rather than procedurally describing how it is to be done, as in 3GLs.

FPE see FUNCTION POINT ESTIMATE.

FTP see FILE TRANSFER PROTOCOL.

Function see BUSINESS FUNCTION, ELEMENTARY BUSINESS FUNCTION, and SYSTEM FUNCTION.

Function Decomposition A technique for modeling business functions by decomposing a single business function into a number of lower level business functions, and then progressively decomposing these until the appropriate level of detail is reached. Function decomposition gives rise to functions arranged in groups or hierarchies known as a business function hierarchy; see also ELEMENTARY BUSINESS FUNCTION, FUNCTION HIERARCHY AND COMPOSITE BUSINESS FUNCTION.

Function Dependency The dependency of one function's commencement upon the completion of another function.

Function Dependency Diagram A visual means of recording dependencies between business functions.

Function Hierarchy A grouping of elementary business functions into one or more hierarchical levels. Typically the highest level corresponds to the company organization, and the middle level corresponds to a grouping of available application functions; see also BUSINESS FUNCTION and FUNCTION DECOMPOSITION.

Function Label A unique ID, within an application system, used for a business function.

Function Name A short, succinct sentence, starting with a verb, describing a business function; see also FUNCTION LABEL.

Function Point Analysis (FPA) A technique used to estimate system size. Using Function Point Analysis, you can calculate system size based on the number of functional element types in the system you are building, as adjusted by its general system characteristics and your technology productivity factor.

Function Point Estimate (FPE) An estimate of work effort produced using Function Point Analysis or an equivalent method.

Functional Currency The principle currency used to record most business transactions and maintain accounting data while working within a particular Oracle Application set of books.

G

Gantt Chart A scheduling tool used to display the status of a project's tasks. A Gantt chart shows each task's duration as a horizontal line. The ends of the lines correspond to the task's start and end dates.

Gap A gap is a relationship between a requirement and an application function where the standard application function will not meet the requirement.

Gap Analysis 1. The process of determining, documenting, and approving the variance between business requirements and system capabilities in terms of packaged application features and technical architecture. 2. The process of determining and evaluating the variance or distance between two items properties being compared. 3. The process of determining and documenting the variance between a business vision and the existing processes and organization.

General Education Course A course that educates the project team or users in fundamental business concepts. It exposes attendees to new business approaches practiced in industry and provides them with a common understanding of relevant business issues.

Generator A mechanism for transforming the specification of a module into executable program code, also known as a code generator.

Generator Template A skeleton or outline program from which a generator can reuse common elements; for example, boilerplate information, window sizes, *OK* and *Quit* buttons.

Gigabyte (GB) A unit of memory or disk space equal to 1,073,741,824 bytes. One Gigabyte is equal to 1,024 Megabytes. Often rounded to 1,000,000,000 bytes.

Goal see BUSINESS GOAL.

Grade Level Relative ranking of jobs based on their difficulty or sphere of responsibility, rather than their job content; see also JOB CLASSIFICATION.

Graphical User Interface (GUI) An interface used with personal computers and workstations that allows the user to access fields and regions of the screen with a pointing device, typically a mouse. The acronym is pronounced "goo-ee".

Group Interview Any session where users, stakeholders, or sponsors collectively discuss the requirements, priorities, design, or implementation of a business solution system; see also FEEDBACK and WORKSHOP.

Guideline Text that provides instructions and advice for performing a task and suggests possible approaches.

GUI See GRAPHICAL USER INTERFACE.

H

Hardware Node A computer on a network; for example, clients and servers.

Hardware Platform The actual physical hardware that supports one or more software server processes.

Help Desk A support system designed to assist end users with technical and functional questions and problems.

Helptext see METHOD HELPTXT.

High-Level Deliverable A deliverable that specifies a framework into which further details can be added; see also DELIVERABLE, DETAILED DELIVERABLE, and INITIAL DELIVERABLE.

HRIS see HUMAN RESOURCE INFORMATION SYSTEM.

HTML See HYPERTEXT MARKUP LANGUAGE.

HTTP See HYPERTEXT TRANSFER PROTOCOL.

HTTP Listener A program on a web server that accepts and processes incoming HTTP requests from web browsers.

Human Performance Support Any process, tool and system that reinforces or encourages the execution of a particular behavior or set of behaviors to meet performance goals.

Human Performance Support Systems an integrated collection of all performance support components (infrastructure, processes, protocols, procedures, tools and practices) for a given group or organization, designed to reinforce or encourage the execution of prescribed behaviors within the group.

Human Performance Technology The field of expertise within organizational development/behavior to set up performance management systems in support of meeting performance expectations.

Human Resources The high-level business function involving the management of human resources and payroll functions of a company; often synonymous with a business organization; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Human Resource Allocation Determining the number and type of job functions and staffing levels appropriate to organizational goals.

Human Resource Planning Forecasting the labor force needs (hiring, termination) for the organization.

Hypertext Markup Language (HTML) A simple language used to format documents, predominantly for viewing with a web browser. Portions of text or images, called hypertext, can be associated with other documents.

Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP) The TCP/IP-based network protocol used to transmit requests and documents between a web server and a web browser.

I

Impact Analysis The process of understanding the complete effect of a particular change; see also CHANGE REQUEST.

Implementation Questionnaire A tool you use to collect business and system information during a business baseline interview. It consists of a pre-built set of questions organized by business function that are to be supplemented by the analyst with relevant company terms and other characteristics before use in driving the interview.

Import Utility An Oracle Database Server utility used to read operating system files written by the Export utility. You use it to restore data into a database.

Index see DATABASE INDEX.

Information Access Model A model that depicts access to key process and organization information for reporting or security purposes.

Information Flow Model A model that visually depicts information flows in the business between business functions, business organizations and applications.

Information Model A model of the information needed to support a business or other activity. Requirements are typically defined as lists of detailed items as well as summarized data from business transactions, such as orders and purchases, and master records, such as customers and vendors. How frequently this information must be made available is also part of the requirement. Information requirements (the what and when) are turned into functional specifications (the how) of an information system by systems analysts. The information is defined as a collection of data elements that are obtained by running query and report programs against a particular database or group of databases. The data and information that is stored in the databases in the first place is also derived from the information requirements; see also DATA MODEL.

Information Systems (IS) A system for managing and processing information, usually computer-based. Also, a functional group within a business that manages the development and operations of the business' information systems.

Information Services Strategy Planning

Method (ISSPM) A method that aligns information technology priorities with business strategies and defines the approach to take to achieve those goals.

Information Warehouse see DATA WAREHOUSE.

Initial Deliverable A deliverable is *initial* if it is intended to be updated later. An initial deliverable is usually preliminary and its content changeable by a later task when more information is known.

Initialization Parameters Parameters defined in an initialization file that configure an Oracle Database Server. The parameters affect how the database performs.

Input Process-Output (IPO) A technique is a generic modeling tool that was designed for framing complete process specifications by identifying: inputs, rules, process step descriptions, tools, and outputs.

Installation The loading of an instance of an application system that is complete, tested, operational, and ready. An installation includes all necessary software, hardware (including terminals, networks, etc.) and documentation, and includes all required data; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM.

Instance 1. An entity to which a set of operations can be applied and which has a state that stores the effects of the operations (UML 1.1 Semantics); see also DATABASE INSTANCE.

Integration Fit Analysis A statement of fit and gaps for integration points between unique applications and installations of the same application.

Integration Test A sequence of steps or set of procedures to verify the inter-operability of various system components; see also SYSTEMS INTEGRATION TEST.

Inter-Company Transaction A transaction between two legal entities that share common ownership, for example, under the same holding company. The two companies usually have an account relationship (for example, an inter-company suspense or clearing account) that facilitates inter-company accounting.

Internal Equity Measure of the fairness of a job's compensation when compared to similar jobs within the same organization.

Internal Concurrent Manager A concurrent manager process that monitors, controls, and dispenses requests to all other concurrent manager processes.

Interface 1. A linkage between systems which can be either automated (via software programs) or procedural (manual). 2. A declaration of a collection of operations that may be used for defining a service offered by an instance. (UML 1.1 Semantics).

Interface Programs A set of programs that systematically link two or more systems to each other.

Internal Process Step A process step that is performed within the business area; see also EXTERNAL PROCESS STEP and PROCESS STEP.

Internet Computing Architecture An Internet-based framework that provides communication in a multi-tier architecture. Also known as the *Internet Computing Model*.

Intranet A network of computers that are internal to a company. A company's intranet is basically a local extension to the globally-distributed Internet, which is a global inter-connected network of computers and smaller computer networks.

Inventory Organization A fundamental Oracle manufacturing and distribution application functional configuration parameter. The inventory organizations are derived by mapping inventory or manufacturing business organizations onto Oracle Applications. Typically they will be manufacturing plants, warehouses, divisions, or departments.

IPO see INPUT-PROCESS-OUTPUT.

IS see INFORMATION SYSTEMS.

ISSPM see INFORMATION SERVICES STRATEGY PLANNING METHOD.

Issue A situation or concern which requires a resolution. Some issues, if not addressed, could adversely impact the success of a project.

IT see ITERATED TASK.

Item Master The master list of all items available for transaction within a product group containing Oracle manufacturing applications. It is also a key application functional configuration parameter.

Iterated Task (IT) A task that is repeated once for each iteration in order to increase the quality of the deliverable to a desired level or to add more detail to the deliverable. Iterated tasks are shown as discrete in the workplan; see also TASK, ITERATION, and ONGOING TASK.

Iteration Indicates the number of times or degree to which a task or task group should be repeated, in order to either increase the quality of the task/group deliverables to a desired level, to add sufficient level of detail, or to refine and expand them on the basis of user feedback. A task or group may be “singly iterated” (the expectation is that it will be performed without repetition in the project), or “multiply iterated” (it will be performed successively, multiple times), resulting in a single deliverable for each task (note this is not true for multiply instantiated tasks). For multiple iterations, it is important for planning purposes to give notes on the number of times or the degree to which a task or group should be iterated, based on experience; see also ITERATIVE BUILD and ITERATIVE DEVELOPMENT.

Iterative Build Iterative construction of an information system by means of a cycle of code (or generate), test, review, starting from a prioritized (MoSCoW) list of requirements and guided by user feedback; see also MOSCOW LIST.

Iterative Development The application of a repeating cycle of the same or similar activities performed on the same piece of functionality that improves or grows into completion through the iterations.

J

JAR (Java Archive) File A collection of Java classes compressed into a single file for faster download to a desktop client.

Java A computing language used, among other things, to produce programs that can be downloaded and run on a desktop client using a web browser. It is also used to produce platform-independent programs that run on a server, either interactively or when invoked through a request from a web browser; see also **APPLET** and **SERVLET**.

Java Class Components of a Java program that define objects and operations performed on objects. In the Architecture and Installation manuals, *Java class* also identifies an operating system file that contains a program or part of a program written in Java.

Java Database Connectivity (JDBC) A Java programming interface that enables Java programs to execute SQL statements and access databases, such as the Oracle Database Server.

Java Virtual Machine An interpreter that translates a compiled Java program, called bytecode, to machine code. JVM makes Java portable, because each operating system's JVM translates bytecode to instructions that the microprocessor can execute. An appletviewer or Java-enabled web browser has an internal JVM that allows it to execute applets or applications written in Java.

JDBC see **JAVA DATABASE CONNECTIVITY**.

Jintitator A browser plug-in that runs a Java applet or application.

Job Analysis Process of obtaining information about jobs; may involve content analysis, interviews, observation, questionnaires, diaries.

Job Classification Process of using job descriptions to organize jobs within a given organization into classes on the basis of duties and responsibilities. Persons within the same job classification are thought to be equally qualified for all other positions within that class; see also **GRADE LEVEL**.

Job Content Duties and responsibilities of a particular position; see also **JOB STRUCTURE**.

Job Description Written description of a job; typically includes job title, summary of major responsibilities, authority and accountability (including reporting relationships), traits or attributes important to the job, and description of tasks.

Job Design/Redesign Creating or adjusting job content to meet new requirements (dictated by new organizational objectives and / or technology-induced change effort); some jobs may be absorbed by other departments or disappear.

Job Enlargement Adding additional but similar duties to a job; also called *Horizontal Loading*.

Job Enrichment Adding more responsibility or authority to a job; also called *Vertical Loading*.

Job Evaluation Analyzing the content of a job to determine level or grade and commensurate compensation.

Job Incumbent Person currently performing the job.

Job Inventory List of tasks presented to job incumbents to verify whether they perform these tasks and to answer qualifying questions about them.

Job Performance Demonstration of skills or competence in a job; sometimes measured by productivity.

Job Structure Duties and responsibilities of a particular position; see also JOB CONTENT.

Job-Person Matching Analyzing skills profiles and worker specifications to determine the best fit between workers and jobs.

JVM see JAVA VIRTUAL MACHINE.

K

Key A way of accessing something. Any set of columns used for retrieval of rows from a table; see also COLUMN and UNIQUE IDENTIFIER.

Key Deliverable A key deliverable represents the culmination, end result, or major milestone of activities performed during a Phase. A major deliverable that is usually reviewed with the client, signed off, and placed under change control. Key deliverables should not be confused with deliverables produced by core tasks. Core tasks produce the minimum set of deliverables needed for every project; key deliverables represent the end result and define the end of each phase. However, not every key deliverable is created for every project. For example, an integration-tested system will only exist on projects where interfaces are constructed; see also DELIVERABLE.

Key Performance Indicator (KPI) A significant measure used on its own, or in combination with other key performance indicators, to monitor how well a business is achieving its quantifiable objectives.

Key Resource A person with a wide range of skills or experiences who can be effective in many types of tasks, or is critical to the completion of a specific task.

KPI see KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATOR.

KSAO Knowledge, skills, aptitudes, and orientation (attitudes, values, etc.).

L

Labor Cost see COST.

Labor Cost Rate The rate (internal cost) for each consulting grade level for delivering services to a client.

Labor Fee see FEE.

Labor Fee Rate The rate (price) for each consulting grade level charged for delivering services to a client.

LAN See LOCAL AREA NETWORK.

Latency In networking, the amount of time it takes a packet of data to travel from a source to its destination. Latency is imposed on the network by devices that delay the forwarding of network packets. The speed and capacity of a network depend on both bandwidth and latency; see also BANDWIDTH.

Leaf Function An function that is not decomposed at the bottom of a function hierarchy. It may be a leaf function because definition is incomplete; see also ATOMIC FUNCTION.

Learner Any individual engaged in acquiring new skills, attitudes, or knowledge, whether with a specified sequence of instruction (intentional) or a random assortment of stimuli (incidental).

Learning Styles psychological traits that determine how individual learners and cultural groups of learners may perceive, interact with, and respond to learning environments.

Learningware Instructional material created to facilitate learning, including paper-based, technology-based and instructor-led media; in OCM, instructional material generated from a custom training curriculum plan, designed to re-skill individuals within the IS department, end-user, and management communities during a new technology implementation.

Legacy Application Interface A heterogeneous interface between Oracle Applications and a pre-existing and preserved legacy system.

Legacy System An existing system repository of information and processes.

Legal Entity A high level business organization that operates within the bounds of a specific set of legal requirements (including currency), typically pertaining to tax regulations and reporting requirements

Line of Business (LOB) Each service within Oracle Services is a line of business. For example, Custom Development, Application Implementation, and Business Process Reengineering are all lines of business.

Link Test A test to identify errors in linked modules of an application system. Link testing is an extension of module testing carried out on a number of levels of detail. Examples include, linked modules of a program, linked programs of a functional area or subsystem, and linked subsystems of the complete application system. The link test is usually a white box test; see also **MODULE INTEGRATION TEST**.

Live Implementation process has ended and the solution is put into production.

Load Balancing Distributing tasks to the server that is least busy when several servers are handling the same workload. For example, the Oracle Forms Load Balancing Cartridge has a single coordinator (the Metrics Server) that monitors load information from other forms servers and determines which server currently has the lightest load. Upon receiving a request from a forms client, the Forms Metrics Server can balance the processing load by instructing the forms client to connect to the forms server that has the lightest load. This server is called the *least loaded host*.

LOB see **LINE OF BUSINESS**.

LOCAL Under Windows NT, an environment setting that identifies the network alias of an ORACLE instance running on the local machine or on another networked machine. This variable overrides any setting for ORACLE_SID and causes the Net8 software to manage the connection request; see also ORACLE_SID and TWO_TASK.

Local Area Network A limited-distance, high-speed, data communications network that allows various data processing resources to be connected and shared. A LAN is a network contained within a single physical site (one or more buildings), as opposed to a WAN; see also **WIDE AREA NETWORK**.

Local Currency The denomination of currency used for transactions in a particular local finance business location.

Localization 1. An enhancement or modification necessary to support specific site requirements not addressed by the base configuration hardware and software. It is developed by and purchased from Oracle. These site specific requirements generally satisfy a government or regulatory agency requirement, although localizations are not limited to this purpose. 2. Modules that extend Oracle Applications to meet the unique business requirements of one or more geographic regions.

Localization Approval The agreement to modify the company standard software and hardware configuration relative to the site requirements.

Localization Tape A tape containing localization programs to be installed to the applications software.

Location see BUSINESS LOCATION.

Logical Application Architecture A complete map of the application instances required to support the applications architecture.

Logical System Design The task of designing a system to support business needs without making final decisions regarding the physical implementation. The same logical design should be appropriate for many physical implementations using; for instance, different versions of a database management system.

Look and Feel The appearance and behavior of a system facility as perceived by the end user. This includes the data, layout, and user interaction through menus, buttons, text editing, and other devices.

M

Management The process of planning, controlling, and completing the execution of an undertaking.

Manual Function A business function that is not system-assisted; see also BUSINESS FUNCTION.

Manufacturing A high-level business function responsible for manufacturing or assembling products; often synonymous with a business organization; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Mapping A technique for establishing application fit to business requirements, identifying gaps and proposing initial solutions. Also a technique to define the relationship between objects; see also APPLICATION FIT and MATRIX DIAGRAM.

Mapping Scenario A plan for and record of business solution testing including: business processes involved in the test, the business conditions that are needed to test the application system, definition of test script execution, support tools required during execution of the test, and a record of test actions; see also BUSINESS SOLUTION TESTING.

Mapping Team A group of people responsible for the modeling, design or mapping for a particular business process.

Margin Amount The difference between the costs (labor, expenses, and overhead) and revenue plus expense reimbursements expressed as a currency amount.

Margin Percentage The ratio between the margin amount and costs, expressed as a percentage.

Marketing A high-level business function responsible for marketing functions within a company; often synonymous with a business organization; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Matrix Diagram A spreadsheet diagram where the axes represent two associated types of elements of interest to information systems developers. A matrix diagram used to express a mapping.

MB see MEGABYTE.

Mechanism 1. A particular technique or technology for delivering a function. Examples might be a telephone, a computer, or an electronic mail service. 2. Resources that enable or facilitate the step/sequence in a test scenario.

Megabyte (MB) A unit of memory or disk space equal to 1,048,576 bytes (1024 x 1024). Often rounded to one million bytes.

Method 1. A system of doing things and handling ideas. A method establishes a network of common tasks, a vocabulary, a set of common processes, estimates, and guidelines for delivering services. 2. The implementation of an operation. It specifies the algorithm or procedure that effects the results of an operation (UML 1.1 Semantics).

Method HelpText The automated form of Oracle Method's handbooks included with every route. This may be accessed directly from the Windows™ desktop or from within Project Bridge Modeler or Project Workbench; also called online help.

Metrics Server A software server that manages and distributes requests from forms clients among multiple forms servers; see also LOAD BALANCING.

MI see MULTIPLY INSTANTIATED TASK.

MIPS (Millions of Instructions Per Second) a measure of computer processing capacity.

MLS see MULTIPLE LANGUAGE SUPPORT.

MO see MULTIPLY OCCURRING TASK.

Module A logical program unit. Examples include: forms, reports, user exits, C programs, PL/SQL procedures, and database triggers; see also SUPPORTING MODULE.

Module Integration Test A test of related modules in an application system using scenario test specifications.

Module Network A technical diagram of modules in an application system that expresses the possible execution paths of business transactions.

Module Process Test Model A detailed testing model for the development and execution of testing. It is identical to the System Process Test Model, with the addition of module references.

Module Test A procedure or sequence of steps that determines whether a module functions properly in isolation from other system components, and conforms to project standards.

MoSCoW List Must have, Should have, Could have, Won't have — a way of classifying and prioritizing requirements or facilities for inclusion in an information system. This mechanism is used in timeboxed development where the scope may need to be redefined according to the rate of progress. The Must have is vital and hence must be developed or included; the Should have is important, but not vital; the Could have is nice to have, but not really important; and finally the Won't have is not developed or included; see also TIMEBOX.

MRC see MULTIPLE REPORTING CURRENCY.

MSOB see MULTIPLE SETS OF BOOKS ARCHITECTURE.

MTEWA Machines, tools, equipment, and work aids used to perform a task.

Multiple Language Support (MLS) Oracle Applications MLS allows the use of multiple simultaneous character sets, and provides translated messages, help files, and seed data for languages other than American English.

Multiple Organization Architecture (Multi-Org) A single installation of any Oracle Applications product to support any number of organizations or different sets of books. The data contained in product schemas is for all organizations and is partitioned by the ORG_ID column in tables.

Multiple Reporting Currency (MRC) An Oracle Applications feature that allows you to create, maintain, and report on accounting records at the transaction level in more than one functional currency.

Multiple Sets Of Books Architecture (MSOB) An older Oracle Applications mechanism for implementing an organization or group of organizations that shares a common Accounting Flexfield structure, calendar, and functional currency. With MSOB architecture, you must define at least one set of books for each business location. This architecture is no longer supported by Oracle Corporation. MSOB architecture is superseded by the newer Multiple Organization Architecture; see also MULTIPLE ORGANIZATION ARCHITECTURE.

Multiply Instantiated Task (MI) A task that may be performed at various times during a project, such as status reports or healthchecks, or a task that is partitioned on a project plan, for example, by multiple teams or functional areas.

Multiply Occurring Task (MO) A task that is repeated at specific, known times during a project. A multiply occurring task is similar to a multiply instantiated task, except the specific occurrences of the task can be planned at the method level. Each occurrence has specific task dependencies which determine when it occurs.

Multi-Tier Architecture A computing model in which various functions are distributed among multiple levels, or tiers, of machines. Typically there are at least three such tiers: desktop clients issuing user requests, back-end servers used for database processing and other intensive tasks, and a middle tier that mediates connections between the two; see also INTERNET COMPUTING ARCHITECTURE.

N

National Language Support (NLS) Oracle Applications NLS allows the use of various character sets and provides translated messages, help files, and seed data for languages other than American English.

Near Real-Time Interface An application interface that supports asynchronous transfer of data between applications. It transfers data with a sufficiently small time delay so as to leave the interfaced applications in states that are very close to synchronized.

Net8 The Oracle product that enables network connectivity between a client machine and the Oracle8 Database Server. Net8 manages communication sessions between these machines by opening and closing sessions and by packaging and sending SQL statements and data responses. Prior to the Oracle8 Database Server release, Net8 was called SQL*Net.

NLS see NATIONAL LANGUAGE SUPPORT.

Node A single computer, group of computers, or mechanism for handling some communication traffic through a particular point on a computer network.

Non-Billable Project Expenses The project expenses that are not billable to a client; see also PROJECT EXPENSES.

Non-Billable Utilization The utilization that is not billable to a client; see also UTILIZATION.

Non-Revenue Entity A legal entity that performs services on behalf of another entity. Such services are usually performed in exchange for an inter-company service fee.

Normalization A step-by-step process of analyzing the data to be represented in order to eliminate data redundancy. It produces either entity or table definitions that have:

- no multi-value attributes or columns
- the same kind of values assigned to all occurrences of any given attribute or column
- a unique name
- uniquely identifiable rows

Null The state of a data item indicating no value. Null is not equivalent to zero.

O

O see ONGOING TASK.

Object Orientation (OO) The perspective that systems should be constructed from objects, which themselves may be aggregations of smaller objects.

Object Technology (OT) The technology, programming languages, development tools, databases, and so on, introduced to support object-oriented systems development.

Objective A statement of business intent that may be measured quantifiably.

OC see ORGANIZATIONAL COMMUNICATIONS.

OCM see ORGANIZATIONAL CHANGE MANAGEMENT.

ODS see OPERATIONAL DATASTORE.

OLAP see ON-LINE ANALYTICAL PROCESSING.

OM see ORACLE METHOD.

Ongoing Task (O) A task that occurs continuously throughout a project, rather than at a specific known time. Ongoing task are shown as continuous on the workplan; see also TASK, PHASE and ITERATED TASK.

On-Line Analytical Processing (OLAP) On-line retrieval and analysis of data to reveal business trends and statistics not directly visible in the data directly retrieved from a data warehouse. Also known as multi-dimensional analysis.

OO see OBJECT ORIENTATION.

Open Systems Organizational systems that are influenced by and interact with their environment.

Operating System The computer software that performs basic tasks such as allocating memory and allowing computer components to communicate.

Operational Datastore (ODS) A data warehouse that is a repository for near real-time operational data rather than long term trend data.

Optional Tasks Additional tasks that may need to be completed during an implementation or migration due to specific project circumstances.

ORACLE_HOME An environment setting that specifies the top directory for Oracle Database Server program files.

Oracle ID An account on a database, comprised of a database username and password.

Oracle Method (OM) Oracle Services' integrated service methodology which consists of workplans, handbooks, and templates used to provide enterprise business system solutions.

ORACLE Schema see SCHEMA.

Oracle Server The database management system used by Oracle Applications. The term refers in general to the product files or the ORACLE instances created using these files.

Oracle Server Manager An Oracle Database Server utility that allows DBAs to start, stop, monitor, and maintain databases.

Oracle Services An Oracle Corporation business organization that provides professional services.

ORACLE_SID An environment setting that identifies an ORACLE instance running on the current machine. See also TWO_TASK and LOCAL.

Oracle Survey Tool A customizable database of questions used by Organizational Change Management to generate surveys, data analyses, and graphical reports for assessments.

ORACLE User ID A username and password used to access an ORACLE instance.

Organization see BUSINESS ORGANIZATION.

Organization Type see BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Organization Unit An element that represents part of the structure of a business. An organizational unit can represent an entire business, a group or department within the business, a person within a group or department or a role; see also AGENT, BUSINESS UNIT, and AGENT CHANNEL.

Organizational Change Management (OCM) An Oracle Services line of business providing change management expertise to organizations seeking to manage the human and organizational factors involved with implementing new technology. Organizational change management includes five service areas: organizational effectiveness assessments, organizational communications, human performance and development, leadership development, and custom training; see also ORGANIZATIONAL EFFECTIVENESS ASSESSMENTS, ORGANIZATIONAL COMMUNICATIONS, and CUSTOM TRAINING.

Organizational Communications (OC)

A Organizational Change Management area that assists organizations in developing and implementing communication and feedback programs that seek to optimize information and buy-in while minimizing resistance to change and promoting a unified vision and open communication among levels of the organization.

Organizational Culture The shared constructs (concepts, modes of thinking, views of itself and others) of an organization.

Organizational Effectiveness The qualitative state at which the organization is functioning to meet its goals. Includes quality of organizational communication, relevance of the performance support system, ability of executives to manage to objectives, core competencies and skills, etc.

Organizational Effort Any activity or set of activities implemented systematically by an organization to achieve a particular goal.

Organizational Readiness The state of an organization's potential to manage change successfully. Involves a consideration of an organization's high-impact leverage points for change, as well as any change impediments.

Organizational Structure The arrangement of jobs into groups, departments, or business units within a given organization.

OT see OBJECT TECHNOLOGY.

Outsourcing The practice of appointing an external organization to provide any or all of the services of the IS department or any other internal service department.

Overhead The operating expenses associated with delivering services, such as rent, light, heat, taxes and non-billable utilization.

Overhead Factor A rate multiplier associated with a category of overhead, e.g., Corporate, Division, or Practice; see also OVERHEAD.

P

Parallel Concurrent Processing In a UNIX environment, distribution of concurrent processes among multiple concurrent processing servers. Also called DISTRIBUTED CONCURRENT PROCESSING.

Parameter A value passed to a command. A parameter can be a file specification, a symbol, or word understood by the program.

Partition A discrete part of the total functionality that is developed in a project. A partition may be a single module, but more often it will be an entire sub-system. A partition may be related to a business area. Partitioning a system also implies a partitioning of the project that develops the system. A separate team develops each partition; see also MODULE, and BUSINESS AREA.

Password An identification word associated with a username that the user must supply to access an ORACLE instance or an Oracle Applications system.

PAT see PERFORMANCE ASSURANCE TEST.

Payment Milestone A significant project event at which time a payment is due. Payment milestones can be progress points, dates, the completion of a task or the production of a deliverable.

Payment Terms The terms and conditions upon which payments will be received from a client.

PBM see PROJECT BRIDGE MODELER.

PCM see PRACTICE MANAGEMENT.

PDF see PORTABLE DOCUMENT FORMAT.

Percentage Adjustment Estimate Total estimate adjusted for organizational factors.

Performance Assurance Test (PAT) A project concerned with simulating an implemented business system for the purposes of predicting its likely performance.

Performance Management Establishing and monitoring performance criteria / standards that contribute to organizational objectives; typically involves goal-setting, measurement, feedback, rating / appraisal, rewards and recognition, and career development.

Performance Support Practice An established or customary set of actions that reinforces or encourages the execution of a particular behavior or set of behaviors, for example, performance review, to meet performance goals.

Performance Support System An integrated collection of all performance support components (infrastructure, processes, protocols, procedures, tools and practices) for a given group or organization, designed to reinforce or encourage the execution of prescribed behaviors within the group.

Performance Support Tool An instrument, such as a performance review form or formula for the calculation of bonuses, that is designed to meet the objectives of a given performance support practice or system.

Performance Technology The field of expertise within organizational development / behavior to set up performance management systems in support of meeting performance expectations.

PGM see PROGRAM MANAGEMENT METHOD.

Phase A chronological grouping of tasks in an approach. Services are delivered by phase in order to reduce project risk. Each phase allows a checkpoint against project goals, and measurement against quality criteria to be made.

Phase Completion The project management tasks which conclude and secure client sign-off of a phase.

Phase Control The project management tasks which execute concurrently with phase execution, and perform project monitoring, directing, and reporting functions during a phase.

Phase Execution The method execution tasks performed during a project phase.

Phase Management The project management tasks required to plan, control and complete the execution of a project phase.

Phase Planning The project management tasks which update project plans and procedures for a phase and secure additional resources necessary to execute that phase.

Physical Application Architecture A complete map of the database instances, their sites, and the application instances and Oracle Ids that they support. This will incorporate aspects of the logical architecture, and the high level designs for security and interfaces.

Pilot An initial project which will serve as a model or template for future projects.

PJM see PROJECT MANAGEMENT METHOD.

Plan A scheme, method or design for the attainment of some objective or to achieve something.

Planned Response System The entire set of business processes in a business area that respond in a predetermined way to a known set of events; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM and EVENT.

Planning (M&D) A high-level business function responsible for manufacturing and distribution planning for one or more manufacturing and distribution business units; often synonymous with a business organization; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Platform Specific computer hardware, as in the phrase “platform-independent.” It may also refer to a specific combination of hardware and operating system and any additional software required by the platform to execute applications code, connect to other platforms across a network, and provide services to other platforms (for example, printing, processing, data storing, etc.). It is also used to refer to support software for a particular activity. Sun SPARC Solaris and DEC Alpha Windows NT are examples of platforms. Some Oracle Applications functionality is platform-specific, meaning its behavior may differ on other platforms.

PL/SQL A procedural extension of SQL that provides programming constructs such as blocks, conditionals, and functions.

Policy A guiding principle, typically established by senior management, which is adopted by an organization or project to influence and determine decisions.

Portable Document Format (PDF) A file format developed by Adobe Systems. PDF files are *snapshots* of formatted document files and may contain formatted text, graphics, color, and images that are viewable, navigable, and printable on multiple platforms. Use the free program Adobe Acrobat Reader to view a PDF file.

Position Ranking Method of comparing whole jobs to one another to rank them in a hierarchy.

Practice Management (PCM) Specifies the process, tasks, and responsibilities regarding the management of a consulting practice. Specifically, this includes client management, project portfolio management, and staff training, recruitment, and growth.

Pre-Sales Cycle The series of activities that occur before the application was selected.

Predecessor A task that precedes another task and is related to it by a task dependency; see also SUCCESSOR.

Prerequisite Something needed by a task, which is produced by a previous task or an external source; see also DELIVERABLE.

Primary Functional Currency The currency you use to record transactions and maintain your accounting data within Oracle Applications.

Primary Set of Books A financial reporting entity in which you conduct business.

Problem A perceived variance between the expected and observed ability of an item to fulfill its defined purpose.

Problem Report The mechanism by which a problem is recorded, investigated, resolved, and verified.

Problem Statement A concise phrase, motto, or goal-oriented explanation of the motivation behind buying a new application system.

Pro*C An Oracle precompiler product that allows developers of C programs to embed standard database calls to an ORACLE database in C programs.

Procedure A written set of steps that specifies how to carry out a business function. If the business function is system-assisted, its corresponding procedure will indicate how the application system carries out that business function; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM and BUSINESS FUNCTION.

Process 1. The sequential execution of functions triggered by one or more events. 2. A discipline or sub-project that defines a set of tasks related by subject matter, required skills and common dependencies. A process usually spans several phases in an approach. Examples are: Data Conversion, Testing, Documentation; see also BUSINESS PROCESS and SYSTEM PROCESS.

Process Analysis A component of a business requirements scenario that facilitates quantitative analysis and measurement of each process step and compares the current to the proposed process in order to sell change to management and to key business people and systems users.

Process Characteristics Attributes that describe a process and how it works including descriptive narrative for its steps, tools required, skill levels required, controls, and performance measures.

Process Flow The passing of execution of a process from one process step to the next. It may include the passing of information or materials from the first step to the second.

Process Flow Diagram A diagram which shows the triggering event(s), sequential flow of process steps, decision points, and deliverable or outcome of a single process.

Process Label A unique reference, within an application system, for a process.

Process Modeling A structured approach used to identify, define, and document the activity performed by a business to produce business deliverables.

Process Narrative A reduction of a new business process design down to a job-level description, thereby defining how the work gets done and laying a foundation for development of a user guide, role-based user training and user certification or other types of readiness testing. One process narrative should be written for each business process; see also ROLE-BASED TRAINING.

Process Owner The agent with overall responsibility for a complete business process; could be the customer of the process, or the supplier (person or organization charged with fulfilling the request).

Process Research A technique used in testing the feasibility of a process model and gathering facts. The approach involves answering implementation questionnaires, reviewing current process documentation, gathering statistics regarding volumes or frequencies, understanding policy statements and measures of performance, interviewing key users to ascertain critical factors for success.

Process Step An instance of the execution of a function as a step in performing a process. In a fully-analyzed business process model, all process steps are instances of elementary business functions. A business process step is normally composed of a series of procedure steps, where tools such as application screens, reports and inquiries are used. Once a process steps begins, all of its procedure steps must be completed in order to achieve an accurate and quality output. Business requirements are defined at the process steps level, while job definitions are at the procedure level.

Product Group Each separate application instance of Oracle Application Object Library in an Oracle database. A product group may contain any number of Oracle Applications products in addition to the single instance of Oracle Application Object Library.

Production Environment The database, equipment, documentation, and procedures used in support of live business operations.

Productivity Measured comparison of the quantity and/or quality of outputs and the quantity of resources required to produce them.

Productivity Metrics Measure by which acceptable performance will be evaluated; may include a time limit, accuracy tolerance, proportion of correct responses required, and/or qualitative standards.

Profile Option An Oracle Applications control switch that a user can set to govern some aspect of system processing or user interface.

Program 1. A set of coded instructions that a computer executes or interprets to perform an automated task. 2. A interrelated group of projects that are either being run concurrently or sequentially and that share a system goal. Individual projects may have different goals, however the combined set of projects will have a program goal.

Program Library The physical location, typically a networked server, used as a shared repository for all program information produced during the life of a program. Contents include issue logs, meeting minutes, status reports, deliverable documents, working papers, project plans, standards, tools, and configured software deliverables. The library is designed to facilitate access to all archived program and project deliverables by all members of a program.

Program Management Method (PGM) Part of Oracle Method designed to provide value-added management, infrastructure, and control to successfully manage complex enterprise-wide implementations of Oracle technology. PGM emphasizes commonality and reusability for management and control processes, execution processes, and hard and soft deliverables.

Program Office A project executed under the sponsorship of program management that establishes commonality and reuse across multiple projects within a program.

Project A set of work processes, tasks with associated deliverables and resources executed over a specific period of time with predetermined budget and business objectives.

Project Bridge Modeler (PBM) Applied Business Technology tool used to build the project planning and estimating system. PBM allows project managers to select, edit, combine, and create project workplans or routes, that best fit the needs of the client.

Project Completion The third and final part of the PJM project life-cycle. The satisfactory conclusion of the project and settlement of all outstanding issues prior to hand over of the project deliverables to the client.

Project Earned Value A measure of the value of completed tasks in a project. There are various ways of measuring the value of a task. These include percentage on commencement, percentage on completion, and amount at milestone.

Project Execution The second part of the PJM project life-cycle. The carrying out of project plans determined during planning for a method approach. Project execution also encompasses elements of control which analyze project performance and take corrective action as needed.

Project Expenses Funds allocated or spent to cover incidental or non-labor costs of a project.

Project Infrastructure The framework for storing, maintaining, and referencing all implementation deliverables and supporting materials including office space, software tools, and standards.

Project Library 1. A system for storing, organizing and controlling all documentation produced or used by the project. 2. The physical location of all deliverables for a single project, plus administrative and support materials. An administrative office to which all members of a team have access.

Project Life-Cycle The organization of a project according to its three major parts: planning, execution, and completion.

Project Management Method (PJM) A method which defines how a project is managed when executed according to the requirements of Oracle Method.

Project Milestone A significant project event.

Project Objectives The set of criteria for measuring a project's success.

Project Office The management of the project library for a specific project.

Project Partition Part of a project usually representing a coherent set of facilities to be developed by a single developer, commonly organized and managed as a sub-project.

Project Planning The first part of the PJM project life-cycle. The definition of a project with respect to scope, quality, time and cost. Project planning also determines the appropriate organization of resources and responsibilities to execute a project.

Project Schedule A list of tasks to be carried out presented against a timetable for their completion.

Project Timeline A specification of work to be carried out together with the number of resources needed to achieve a target duration; see also PROJECT SCHEDULE.

Project Workbench (PMW) Applied Business Technology tool used to schedule, track, and analyze your project. PMW provides work breakdown structures based on the routes selected in Project Bridge Modeler and provides the capability to manage these plans.

Project Workplan A specification of the work to be performed for a project, expressed as a set of interdependent tasks with project resources allocated over time.

Property Any detail that serves to qualify, identify, classify, quantify, or express the state of an element in a repository.

Prototype A facsimile of an end product used to demonstrate a concept rapidly, check feasibility, or gain acceptance.

Prototyping The construction of a partial system to demonstrate some aspect or aspects of the intended system behavior in order to gain user acceptance or to establish technical feasibility.

Publish and Subscribe A data communication paradigm for implementing the data flow between two or more applications. An event in a source application causes the application to 'publish' a data object or message to the potentially interested applications who individually opt to 'subscribe' to the data object or message. The subscription of the interested applications to the data object or message causes a state change in the applications. Contrast Request-Reply.

PMW see PROJECT WORKBENCH.

Q

Quality Audit An audit used to assess the adherence of the project team to plans, procedures, and standards.

Quality Management The means of implementing quality policy. On a particular project this is achieved through quality planning; quality assurance; quality control; and quality improvement.

Quality Review A review used to assess the quality of a deliverable in terms of fitness for purpose and adherence to defined standards and conventions.

Questionnaire A written or electronic survey instrument comprised of a series of questions, designed to measure a specific item or set of items.

R

RBT see ROLE-BASED TRAINING.

RDBMS see RELATIONAL DATABASE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM.

Real-Time Interface An application interface that supports synchronous transfer of data between applications.

Real-Time Support System (RTSS) An electronic information system accessible by Oracle and the client.

Real-Time System A system in which events control actual mechanisms. Real-time systems often control machinery (for example, a control system for an aircraft) and are often time- or safety-critical; see also EVENT.

Record In a non-relational database system, a record is an entry in a file, consisting of individual elements of information, which together provide full details about an aspect of the information needed by the system. Individual elements are held in fields and all records are held in files. An example of a record might be an employee. Every detail of the employee for example, date of birth, department code, or full names will be found in a number of fields. In a relational system record is an alternate word for row; see also ROW.

Record Type A predetermined set of fields within a file.

Readiness State of a person's, group's or organization's potential to manage change successfully. Involves a consideration of high-impact leverage points for change, as well as any change impediments.

Reference Materials Documents that describe key aspects or samples for the current business. These are normally compiled before the project starts and may have been used during the pre-sales cycle.

Registry An embedded database that holds configuration information for the Windows NT operating system. During installation, Oracle Applications writes data to the registry. You can also edit the registry directly with the Registry Editor (regedt32.exe).

Registry Key A folder that appears in the left pane of the Registry Editor window. A key can contain subkeys and value entries. For example: Environment is a key of HKEY_CURRENT_USER; see also REGISTRY SUBKEY.

Registry Subkey A key within a key. Subkeys are analogous to subdirectories in the registry hierarchy. Keys and subkeys are similar to the section heading in .ini files. However, subkeys can carry out functions. Oracle Applications stores important information about a product group in a registry subkey; see also REGISTRY KEY and REGISTRY.

Regression Test Specific assurance testing on an application system release, after defects have been corrected or enhancements have been completed. Regression testing is required to re-validate an application system, confirming that prior validations have not regressed.

Relational Database Management System

(RDBMS) A database management system in which data can be viewed and manipulated in tabular form. Data can be sorted in any order and tables of information are easily related or joined to each other.

Relationship 1. What one entity has to do with another. 2. Any significant way in which two things of the same or different type may be associated.

Release A baseline issued from the CM Repository for delivery to an a destination. The destination may be internal to the project environment, such as for testing, or external, such as to the client.

Remote Procedure Call (RPC) A protocol that allows a client to execute a program on a server. The client sends a message to the server with appropriate arguments, and the server returns a message containing the program's results.

Report An organized display of Oracle Applications information. A report can be viewed online or printed. The content of a report can range from a summary to a complete listing of values.

Reporting Database A database used by reporting applications. Reporting databases are often duplicates of transaction databases used to off-load report processing from transaction databases.

Reporting Functional Currency A currency, other than your primary functional currency, for which you need to generate reports.

Report Review Agent A tool used by Oracle Applications to view concurrent processing files online.

Reporting Set of Books A financial reporting entity that is associated with a primary set of books. It has the same chart of accounts and accounting calendar, but usually a different functional currency.

Repository A mechanism for storing any information about the definition of a system at any point in its life-cycle. Repository services would typically be provided for extensibility, recovery, integrity, naming standards, and a wide variety of other management functions.

Representative Sample A scientifically selected group of individuals, who provide information that allows mathematical inferences to be made about the larger constituency they are chosen to represent.

Request for Proposal The formal mechanism by which a company conveys its business requirements during the search for a new application system. Known as the RFP, this document drives the pre-sales cycle and provides valuable information into the business requirements definition process of the implementation; see also PRE-SALES CYCLE.

Requirement A requirement is a specific, detailed business need which is to be compared with application functionality to determine if the need can be met with the standard Oracle software.

Requirements Scenario A requirements scenario is a formal statement of detailed business requirements for a process, the source of the requirements, how these requirements will be satisfied (either the application, manual procedure, workarounds, or other application solutions) and what prototyping steps must be taken to prove the design.

Requirements Workshop A workshop, usually attended by project sponsor, stakeholders, and developers, to provide a sufficiently detailed definition for a developer to commence build. The definition will be further defined and refined during development, particularly by user reviews; see also USER REVIEW and WORKSHOP.

Research and Development These business organizations are responsible for the research and product development functions within a company; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Resource Any persons, equipment, or material needed to perform a task(s).

Resource Category see CONSULTING GRADE LEVEL.

Resource Database A record of the resources available, primarily human resources, including information about the skills and experiences of the resources.

Respondent In OCM, any individual who provides information in response to a survey, such as a questionnaire or interview.

Responsibility 1. A contract or obligation of a type or class. (UML 1.1 Semantics) 2. A collection of functions within an Oracle Application. Each Applications user is assigned one or more responsibilities to allow them access to Applications forms.

Revenue Income from services labor fees, training fees, licensed product sales and support fees.

Revision The authorized modification to a configuration item.

Rewards and Recognition Means by which individuals are reinforced or compensated for certain behaviors; may be tangible/symbolic, verbal/social, cash/non-cash, immediate or long-term. EX: bonuses, team celebrations, profit-sharing, outstanding contributor awards.

Risk 1. The potential of an adverse condition occurring on a project which will cause the project to not meet expectations. A risk requires management assessment and a strategy for its mitigation. 2. The logical product of the impact of the risk and the likelihood of it occurring.

Role A classification of staff member used on a project. Examples are: analyst, application developer, system architect; see also RESOURCE.

Role-Based Training (RBT) A user training approach that focuses on developing curriculum based on Oracle Application responsibilities (i.e., roles) that have been defined and assigned to users. Application responsibilities tie a user to a menu of functions that can be performed. An RBT curriculum trains a group of users on these specific functions, using client data and highlighting client procedures.

Rollback Segment A set of entries used to undo changes in the database in the event of transaction rollback, crash, or media recovery.

Rollback Tablespace A tablespace created for rollback segments.

Route A variation of a method containing all tasks required in order to deliver a service; a dependency network.

Row An entry in a table that typically corresponds to an instance of some real thing, consisting of a set of values for all mandatory columns and relevant optional columns. A row is often an implementation of an instance of an entity; see also COLUMN and TABLE.

RPC see REMOTE PROCEDURE CALL.

RTSS see REAL-TIME SUPPORT SYSTEM.

Rule of 3-2-1 A rule of thumb used during process research that stresses the importance of “walking the floor” and other practical investigation over conference room interviews. It means that roughly 3 hours of research are normally required for every 2 hours of process design and 1 hour of formal deliverable creation (like creating a BRS using a template or other tool); see also PROCESS RESEARCH and BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS SCENARIO.

S

Sales Business organizations that handle typical sales functions, including generating quotes and sales orders; see also BUSINESS ORGANIZATION TYPE.

Sample A statistically-significant subset selected and analyzed to estimate the characteristics of a larger group or population; a set of individuals within an organization assessed to provide information on the preferences, opinions, attitudes, and practices of the group they represent.

Schema 1. An information model implemented in a database. A schema may be a logical schema, which will define, for example, tables, columns, and constraints, but which may not include any optimization. It may be a physical schema that includes optimization, for example, table clustering. 2. An ORACLE account or ORACLE ID.

Scenario A discrete instance of a system process; see also **MAPPING SCENARIO**.

Scenario Test Specification A component of a test script which defines the test execution – it is comprised of scenario information, system process information, a series of test steps, and their associated data profiles.

Scope The boundaries of a project expressed in some combination of geography, organization, applications or business functions.

Scope Change A change to project scope. A scope change requires an adjustment to the project workplan, and nearly always impacts project cost, schedule or quality.

Scope Creep The common phenomenon where additional requirements are added after a project has started without reconsidering the resourcing or timescale of the project. Scope creep arises from the misapprehension that such small additions will not affect the project schedule.

Scoping Workshop A workshop, usually attended by the project sponsor and developers, with the objective of defining the boundaries of the scope for an intended project prioritizing requirements within the scope; see also **WORKSHOP**.

Script 1. A sequence of coded instructions executed or interpreted by computer programs.
2. A prescribed set of steps to follow when testing.

Security Profile A list of role-based security specifications.

Sequence A database object created such as a table used to generate unique keys (sequence numbers).

Server A program or machine that provides resources, such as files, processing, or other information, to other programs or machines, which are called clients. For example, the Oracle Forms Server process runs on a forms server (machine), and the Oracle Database Server (database process) runs on a database server. Server processes may communicate with other programs, such as desktop client processes or other servers. Do not use the term *server* in an unqualified sense. Use *Hardware Server*, *Applications Server*.

Service 1. Work performed (or offered) by a server. This may mean simply serving simple requests for data to be sent or stored (as with file servers, gopher or http servers, e-mail servers, finger servers, SQL servers, etc.) or a more complex work, such as that of irc servers, print servers, X Windows servers, or process servers. 2. A Windows NT internal software routine that provides support for other applications. The Oracle Database Server, Net8, and Oracle Applications concurrent managers all make use of services.

Servlet A Java program executed on a web server rather than downloaded to a desktop client; see also **APPLET**.

Set of Books A company or group of companies within Oracle Applications that share a common chart of accounts, accounting calendar, and functional currency. This concept is being superseded by the concept of a financial organization in releases of Oracle Applications starting with 10.6.

SGA see **SYSTEM GLOBAL AREA**.

Shared Localization A customization to an application product required by more than one country.

Shared Product see **DEPENDENT PRODUCT**.

Short Name An abbreviation for an Oracle Applications product (such as GL for Oracle General Ledger).

Shut Down The process of stopping an active process, such as an ORACLE instance or a concurrent manager, to make it unavailable.

SI see SINGLY INSTANTIATED TASK.

Signoff Agreement with a client of the successful completion of a project, project phase, or deliverable.

Singly Instantiated Task (SI) A task which occurs once, at a specific time, during a project.

Site A uniquely identifiable geographic location or place from which one or more business organizations may be wholly or partly operating.

Site Based Configuration Specific modifications or enhancements made to the company base configuration to support site requirements. The site base configuration must remain integrated with the company base configuration to maintain integrity of the company base configuration; see also COMPANY BASE HARDWARE CONFIGURATION.

Site Configuration The definition and management of the site base configuration.

Skills Analysis The collection of data from groups and individuals targeted in a specific training situation, to determine the existence and nature of any performance gap(s); used in a skills assessment to determine training needs and develop training goals and objectives to be translated into learningware recommendations.

Skills Database see RESOURCE DATABASE.

Skills Profile Description of the skills held by a particular job incumbent or group of incumbents at a given point in time.

Skills Set Collection of physical or mental capabilities inherent in and available to a given individual.

SmartClient An implementation used with Release 10 to provide client/server access to Oracle Applications. Use of SmartClient is no longer recommended by Oracle Corporation for new implementations.

Software Management (SWM) A program management focus area project that defines and establishes a common software infrastructure for a multi-site implementation. Included items are development environment; software distribution; version control; and software configuration management methodology.

Solution A solution is the resolution of the discrepancy between one or more gaps and one or more standard application functions. A solution may take the form of a procedure, policy or customization.

Source Module A physical program unit. An application system's repository of source code is controlled at the source module level.

SQL see STRUCTURED QUERY LANGUAGE.

SQL*Loader An Oracle Database Server tool used to load unstructured data from operating system files into Oracle Database Server database tables.

SQL*Plus An Oracle program you can use to enter and run SQL commands and PL/SQL blocks that store data in and retrieve data from an ORACLE database.

SQL Script A file containing SQL statements that you run, with a tool such as SQL*Plus, to query or update ORACLE data.

Stakeholder A person, group, or business unit that has a share or an interest in a particular activity or set of activities.

Standard A set of rules for measuring quality. Usually, standards are defined for products deliverables or deliverable components and processes.

Standard Request Submission A standard interface in Oracle Applications that lets you run and monitor concurrent requests.

State A recognizable or definable condition that a system or an object can be in at some point in its life-cycle.

State Transition A valid change of a system or an object from one state to another, modeled on a state transition diagram; see also STATE.

Store A collection of information or materials used in a process.

Storyboard A technique, borrowed from the film industry, for describing screen dialogues. A storyboard consists of an ordered series of pictures illustrating stages of the dialogue. The pictures are annotated with notes about logic and user input.

Structured Query Language (SQL) The ANSI internationally accepted standard for relational database systems, covering not only query but also data definition, manipulation, security, and some aspects of referential and entity integrity.

Subdirectory A directory that is contained within another directory.

Sub-Function A business function that has a parent function.

Sub-Process A process performed entirely within another process.

Successor A task that follows another task and is related to it by a dependency link; see also PREDECESSOR.

Support Profile A section of a test scenario that identifies support tools required during execution of the test.

Supporting Module A module that is not itself an entry point in an application system. Supporting modules are generally shared modules that provide functionality used by multiple primary modules. They are usually not referenced independently in user-oriented documentation. All PL/SQL packages, procedures, and database triggers are examples of supporting modules; see also MODULE.

Swim Lane see AGENT CHANNEL.

Synonym 1. A name assigned to a table or view that may then be used more conveniently for reference. 2. An alternate name for an entity.

Syntax The orderly system by which commands, qualifiers, and parameters are arranged together to form valid command strings.

SYS Username A database user which is automatically created in Oracle Database Servers upon installation and initialization. This user owns the tables and database objects that make up the Oracle data dictionary.

System A named, defined, and interacting collection of procedures and processes, along with the organized deployment of people, machines, various mechanisms, and other resources that carry out those procedures and processes; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM.

System Architecture A representation of the structure of an application system usually confined to essentials.

System Facility A part of an information system that supports an identifiable set of business functions. A facility may be a single module or it may be a whole sub-system.

System Function Something a computer system does in order to support one or more business functions; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM and BUSINESS FUNCTION.

System Global Area (SGA). A reserved section of main memory that provides communication between all database users and the ORACLE background processes.

System Interface The mechanism used to create connectivity between two systems.

System Operations Function A system function that serves to support the continuing operations of the application system. Examples are backup, recovery, audit; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM, SYSTEM FUNCTION, and SYSTEM OPERATIONS PROCEDURE.

System Operations Procedure A step-by-step indication of the way in which an application system executes a system operations function. The system operations guide is a CDM deliverable that is a compilation of all relevant system operations procedures; see also APPLICATION SYSTEM.

System Process The response which an application system makes to an event. It comprises the sequential execution of both manually executed process steps which are instances of manual functions and process steps automatically executed by a computer system which are instances of system functions.

System Process Test Model The overall basis for testing the functional requirements of a system. The system process test model contains scenarios, data profiles, and test specifications, but no module references.

SYSTEM Tablespace Holds data dictionary tables owned by the SYS account. It is created when you install the database.

System Test A project activity that tests an application system over its complete life-cycle, using scripts and associating scenario test specifications into chronological sequences.

System Test Flow A set of steps or a transaction sequence used in system or business process testing.

SYSTEM Username One of two standard usernames automatically created with each database (the other is SYS). This user owns the views created on the data dictionary tables. The SYSTEM username is the preferred username to use when performing database maintenance. See also SYS USERNAME.

Systems Integration Test A project activity that consists of testing related application systems using sequences or scripts from two or more systems which interface.

T

Table The basic unit of storage in a relational database management system, defined by one or more columns of data and a primary key. A table represents entities and relationships.

Table Constraint A set of rules constraining values in a combination of one or more columns of a database table.

Tablespace A logical portion of an ORACLE database used to allocate storage for data and to group related logical structures. For example, one tablespace may contain all of one Oracle Applications product's database tables and indexes.

TAR see TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE REQUEST.

Target Application The primary set of new application modules that are within project scope.

Task A unit of work that done in delivering a service. A task is the smallest trackable item on a project plan, and forms the basis for a work breakdown structure. The minimum elapsed time for a task iteration or instantiation should be one day. The maximum should be two weeks; see also WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE.

Task Dependency The relationship between two tasks where the start or end date of the successor task is constrained by the start or end date of the predecessor task.

Task Dependency Network A network of tasks and task dependencies where each node is a task and each link is a task dependency; see also CRITICAL PATH METHOD (CPM) NETWORK.

Task Group A set of tasks that should be treated similarly. For example, they should be performed at the same time, should be iterated as a group, should be multiply instantiated as a group. A task group is represented on a process flow diagram by enclosing the tasks in a rectangle.

Task Step A discreet step to be done in executing a task.

TCP/IP See TRANSMISSION CONTROL PROTOCOL / INTERNET PROTOCOL.

Technical Architecture The physical hardware, network configuration, and software tools that support the system architecture.

Technical Assistance Request (TAR) Oracle's name for recorded problems. A TAR number is a unique number assigned by WWSUP to track the problem.

Technical Platform Architecture Setup rules, guidelines, and principles that define the structure, functions, and relationships among the hardware, systems software, communications, and network facilities that act as the technical foundation for the business process, information, and application architectures. The technical platform architecture specifies the common or shared facilities and function of the facilities needed to support the applications and data to meet the needs of the business. It supports such established principles as data, devices, and location independence and formal interfaces.

Technique A specific approach to performing a task. A methodical means of handling and communicating complex details.

Temporary Tablespace A tablespace used when a SQL statement requires the creation of temporary segments (for example, the creation of an index).

Test Data Profile Specific test data values for performing a test.

Test Environment A combination of software and possibly hardware that provides a stable environment in which to test newly developed software without elaborate preparation. A test environment might provide test data; data structures; test scripts; automatic test execution; test results recording; and test results analysis.

Test Scenario An instance of an event. A point-in-time sample of the business conditions and processing environment to be tested. Each scenario may include users working in multiple applications, performing online or batch processing being performed.

Test Script A document consisting of a test specification, a test data profile and instructions for performing a test.

Test Specification A set of steps or a transaction sequence used in module; module integration; system; systems integration; or entity testing.

Thin Client 1. A client is considered thin if the personal database and Express Server are installed on the server and all processing occurs on the server. 2. A low-maintenance desktop client, usually without a hard drive, intended for optimal use in a multi-tier architecture environment. In a multi-tier environment, server hardware platforms perform data processing actions instead of the thin client. 3. The client software that is running on the server hardware platform. See also TIER.

Third-Generation Programming Language (3GL) A programming language that uses procedural definitions to carry out tasks, and typically uses record-by-record processing of data. Procedural 3GL language structures include *if....then....else, do....while* statements and others.

Third-Party Application Interface A heterogeneous interface between Oracle Applications and the application product of another vendor or an application developed 'in-house'.

Tier A set of hardware platforms that perform similar tasks. For example, client/server is a two-tier architecture, with hardware platforms on the client tier connecting to machines on the server tier. A multi-tier architecture consists of three or more tiers. In Release 11, hardware platforms on the desktop client tier communicate with hardware platforms on the application tier, which in turn, communicate with each other and with the hardware platforms on the database tier.

Timebox A project management technique that fixes the duration and resources of a task, or a set of tasks, and forces the scope of the project to be adjusted based on the time available to complete the task(s). The contingency for under-estimation of the work is provided by a prioritized list of features left out if necessary. The contingency for over-estimation is provided by a prioritized list of features that should be added in if time allows.

Tool Software applications, deliverable templates, or any other utility suggested to facilitate the completion of a particular task.

Top-Down Estimate A high-level work effort estimate. This type of estimate is derived by taking a total project estimate and dividing it among the project's phases, activities, and tasks.

Topical Essay A high-level illustration of how to satisfy a business need. A section of a design document that specifies business needs, major features, terms, and processing overview.

Traceability The ability to trace an application system component to its business requirement.

Train-the-Trainer An approach toward training whereby inside resources take ownership of delivering training to their peers and associates.

Transaction Database A database used primarily by transaction oriented applications.

Transaction Interface An interface that transfers transaction data between similar or dissimilar applications.

Transmission Control Protocol / Internet Protocol (TCP/IP) A popular industry-standard networking protocol used for communication between computers.

Trigger 1. A database object that executes PL/SQL code based on a change to a database table. 2. An Oracle Forms function that is executed based on an event in the forms environment.

TWO_TASK With a UNIX operating system, an environment setting that identifies the network alias of an ORACLE instance running on the local machine or on another networked machine. This variable overrides any setting for ORACLE_SID and causes the Net8 software to manage the connection request. See also ORACLE_SID and LOCAL.

U

Uncontrolled Document A document which is produced once for information only, and is not subject to formal approval or change control.

Unique Identifier Any combination of attributes or relationships that serves, in all cases, to uniquely identify an occurrence of an entity.

Unit Test see MODULE TEST.

Usability That quality of a system that makes it easy to learn, easy to use and encourages the user to regard the system as a positive help in getting the job done.

User A person who uses a system to perform a business function.

User Preferences In many circumstances in computer systems there may be alternate ways a user can influence the behavior of a utility, user interface, or other system process. Typically set by adjusting values in a set of user preferences; for example, in a program generator, preferences may be set for style, performance, user interface behavior, and code standards.

User Review A meeting at which some of the facilities of a system are demonstrated to and reviewed by user. The objective of a user review is to elicit feedback on which to base future development and improvement of the facilities being reviewed.

Utility 1. A program or system function that performs a job for the users, but does not provide or require user interaction (for example, the calculation of interest); see also GENERATOR and TRANSFORMER. 2. A program that performs a job for developers or for administrators (for example, Headstart utilities).

Utilization The amount of time a staff member books to a project accounting system; see also BILLABLE UTILIZATION and NON-BILLABLE UTILIZATION.

V

Vanilla 1. Standard or plain. 2. An ice cream flavor.

Variance The difference between a planned and an actual value; for example, budgeted hours vs. actual hours.

Version The rendering of a configuration item which incorporates all of its revisions starting from a given point.

Version Control A mechanism to manage multiple revisions of files, documents, programs, applications, or other items that undergo change.

View 1. A means of accessing a subset of data in a database. 2. A custom-tailored presentation of the data in one or more tables. A view can be thought of as a *stored query*.

W

Walkthrough Review of work in progress, usually taking the form of a presentation by a developer to an audience of stakeholders or fellow developers who are encouraged to comment and ask questions. The objective is to make sure that work is proceeding in the right direction.

WAN see WIDE AREA NETWORK.

WBS see WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE.

Web Browser A program running on a desktop client used for viewing documents formatted in HTML and running Java applets. A web browser sends requests to a web server using a special protocol (HTTP) to retrieve documents and Java applets.

Web Client see THIN CLIENT and TIER.

Web Server A type of application server that runs an HTTP listener. The term is also used by some in an informal manner to describe the software running the HTTP listener, as in "the Apache web server".

White Box Test A test of all or part of an application system that requires knowledge of the actual code being tested. Module tests are usually white box tests; see also BLACK BOX TEST.

Wide Area Network (WAN) A communications network that connects geographically separated areas; see also LOCAL AREA NETWORK.

Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) An organization of project tasks into a hierarchy for scheduling and reporting progress.

Work Effort see EFFORT.

Work Estimate see ESTIMATE.

Workflow 1. The flow of work, step-by-step, through a process, including inputs required, outputs produced, activities undertaken and decisions made. 2. The movement of documents around an organization for purposes including sign-off, evaluation, performing activities in a process and co-writing. 3. The flow of inputs and outputs linking one job or one task to the next in a work process.

Work Schedule see PROJECT SCHEDULE.

Workshop 1. A meeting attended by users and developers to create a plan, specification or other documentation that can guide the developers in their development tasks. 2. A meeting designed to facilitate interaction and the exchange of information between individuals or groups; see also REQUIREMENTS WORKSHOP, SCOPING WORKSHOP, and USER REVIEW.

Workstep A step within a task that may produce a deliverable component.

Worldwide Support (WWSUP) Oracle's support organization.

World Wide Web (WWW) A hypertext-based system for browsing multimedia documents that uses the Internet as its transport mechanism. In a hypertext system, you navigate among documents by following hyperlinks, which take you to other documents. Often simply referred to as the *Web*. See also HTML and HTTP.

WWSUP see WORLDWIDE SUPPORT.

WWW see WORLD WIDE WEB.

